The road outside the Saidapet terminus was more or less empty. Shops, except those selling tea and food, were all shut. The crowd was much thinner. A column of autorickshaws waited for the last passengers. A drunk man staggered across the street. The CRPF commandos and Tamil Nadu Police personnel maintained their positions, but a sense of hopelessness seemed to have crept in. Suddenly there was a message on the wireless set, 'Suspect in sight, suspect in sight. Over.' The message was from a commando positioned on a rooftop. He was adjusting his night-vision binoculars to properly see the face of the 'suspect'. Everyone jumped into action. Ravindran spoke on the wireless next, 'Maintain calm, maintain calm. Position of suspect?'

A couple had just alighted from a bus. There were very few other passengers with them. The wireless said, 'Near the main exit, near the main exit ... a male and a female ... Male has head covered … Male has head covered in towel … Over.'

Ravindran wasted no time in approaching the couple, who were near the main exit by then. Verma was inches behind Ravindran. 'Watch out … they may be carrying grenades … I will tackle Murugan and my boys the lady. You stay behind,' Ravindran told Verma.

Ravindran picked up pace, and his plainclothes commandos followed suit. The Black Cats stationed inside the compound scaled the walls, landed on the road outside the depot and quietly encircled the duo headed towards the autorickshaw stand.

Ravindran was right behind the man. Seeing one of his commandos quietly walking next to Nalini, Ravindran signalled with a nod. In a fraction of a second, the commandos pounced upon Nalini, and Ravindran caught hold of the towel covering Murugan's head and pulled it over his face to avoid him taking a cyanide pill. Murugan struggled at first and then reached for Ravindran's throat. But Ravindran wound the towel tighter, incapacitating him.

Verma watched the Black Cats put Nalini into a car. A few metres away, Murugan managed to grab Ravindran's pistol and held the muzzle against his abdomen while Ravindran used his arms to restrain Murugan. Verma